

Etsy Competitive Research & Keep Waco Wagging Comparison

Prepared for Keep Waco Wagging (KWW) · Data collected late June / July 2026

About the data

Etsy does not publish seller revenue. Every "sales," "admirers," "rating," and "Star Seller" figure below is a **public proxy** read directly from each shop's Etsy page — a labeled estimate of scale and traction, not audited revenue. Prices reflect listed/sale prices at the time of collection and shift frequently on Etsy.

Nine shops were studied across three competitive lanes:

- **Lane 1 — Dog Mom & Breed Apparel:** slogan and breed-graphic tees
- **Lane 2 — Personalized Pet Apparel:** photo/name customization at scale
- **Lane 3 — Local-City / Hometown Dog Merch:** a mix of Texas/regional and national "hometown dog" examples

Lane 1 — Dog Mom & Breed Apparel

Breed-specific "dog mom" identity and funny-saying graphic tees. Volume is moderate; the winning shops rely on breadth of breed coverage and humor, not personalization.

PupMoms — Jupiter, FL

PupMoms on Etsy shows 8,367 sales, 842 admirers, and a 4.6 rating across 1,183 reviews, on Etsy since 2017. The catalog is DTG-printed graphic tees (\$17.99–21.99) and mugs (\$12.99–19.99). Designs are breed + "Mom" slogans (dachshund, pitbull, golden, bulldog, doodle, corgi, frenchie, yorkie) plus funny sayings like "Only Talking to Dogs Today" and "Pugs Not Drugs." Some mugs are name-personalized, but apparel is graphic-only.

- **Occasions:** Mother's Day, birthday
- **Reviews:** repeat gift buyers praise fit, print quality, and humor
- **Gaps:** no photo personalization; no breed-silhouette apparel; limited premium blanks

PeaceLovePups — Birchwood, WI

PeaceLovePups is a Star Seller with 3,130 sales, 270 admirers, and a 4.9 rating across 782 reviews, on Etsy since 2019. Interestingly, the shop skews to **drinkware** — frosted glass breed cups (\$19.99), tumblers, and breed Christmas ornaments (\$9.99) — with a small apparel line

(sweatshirt ~\$29.49). It covers roughly 40 breeds and runs Halloween tarot-card tumblers plus rescue/adoption themes.

- **Occasions:** Christmas, Halloween, Mother's Day
- **Reviews:** owner "Lynn" is praised for gift-quality items, fast shipping, breed accuracy
- **Gaps:** apparel is secondary to drinkware; thin tee/sweatshirt catalog

SChousebyDaniel — Los Angeles, CA

SChousebyDaniel is a **Star Seller** (sales count not shown) built on Comfort Colors custom dog-portrait and dog-ears line-art tees (\$20.89–29.35), hoodies (\$22.78), and even pet wedding napkins (\$48.97). Themes lean retro/90s/varsity with wavy custom text.

- **Occasions:** weddings, Christmas, birthday
- **Reviews:** "added 3 dogs to one shirt — so beyond happy" (Briell); "Repeat customer x4" (Kelsey); "Exceeded my expectations!" (Trinity)
- **Gaps:** no hometown/city angle; premium-only pricing limits impulse buys

Lane 2 — Personalized Pet Apparel

The highest-volume lane by far. Photo + name personalization is the engine — these shops sell hundreds of thousands of units.

ModPawsUS — New York, NY

ModPawsUS is a personalization powerhouse: **296,403 sales, 23,786 admirers, and a 4.7 rating across 61,812 reviews**, Star Seller since 2020. The bestseller is a **Custom Comfort Colors Vintage Bootleg Pet Shirt (pet photo + name)** at \$8 (down from \$19.99, 60% off), alongside custom pet mugs (\$9.20), blankets (\$9.99), and phone cases (\$7.50). Personalization spans photo + name, portraits, ornaments, sweaters, and memorial products across 20+ product types (blankets, pillows, stockings, suncatchers).

- **Occasions:** Christmas, memorial, birthday
- **Reviews:** high-volume 5-star; praise for likeness, speed, and value
- **Gaps:** ultra-low pricing signals a race to the bottom; brand dilution across too many products

natruyenshop — Santa Ana, CA

natruyenshop has **158,509 sales, 3,670 admirers, and a 4.8 rating across 21,952 reviews**, Star Seller since 2020. Its distinct angle is **apparel worn by the dog** — Personalized Dog Shirts with name/logo/photo/QR code (\$5.99–7.99), dog jerseys (\$11.24), and bandanas (\$5.24) — plus some non-pet items (nurse bags, pickleball).

- **Occasions:** birthday, gotcha-day, sports events
- **Reviews:** praise for custom fit on dogs, QR-code novelty, fast turnaround

- **Gaps:** human-apparel line is thin; the brand is unfocused (mixes in non-pet items)

Lane 3 — Local-City / Hometown Dog Merch

This niche is genuinely thin. No established shop dominates "city/state + dog." Below is a mix of high-volume Texas sellers and a national hometown-dog format example.

CustombyTexas — Houston, TX

CustombyTexas has 23,447 sales, 940 admirers, and a 4.9 rating across 3,646 reviews, Star Seller since 2024. It runs a broad Comfort Colors + budget-tee catalog (budget tees \$7.24 on sale from \$14.49; Comfort Colors \$18.99) that includes a Comfort Colors "Dog Mom" line — but it is a general occasion-graphics shop (mom, teacher, baseball, patriotic), not city/state-dog specific.

- **Occasions:** Mother's Day, patriotic, Christmas
- **Reviews:** high-volume 5-star; fast Texas shipping and print quality
- **Gaps:** dog is one category among many; no hometown-dog identity

DoggieMerch — Leander, TX

DoggieMerch is a Printify shop run by dog trainer/"Dog Dad" Trevor Smith with ~188 items but low review volume (only 6 shown). It focuses on breed + dog-sport tees (agility, dock diving) at \$18.97–30 and breed stickers (\$7.13), with mauve/purple palettes and free customization.

- **Occasions:** Halloween, Day of the Dead, Christmas
- **Reviews:** few reviews; niche credibility from a working dog trainer
- **Gaps:** very low sales; no city-skyline system; weak discovery/SEO

UIdeaAtelier (brand "DOGGO") — Washington, US

UIdeaAtelier is brand new (2026, only 2 sales, 0 admirers, no reviews) — included as a format example only. It sells Comfort Colors 1717 tees (\$29.91) with strong state/city landmark dachshund designs: all 50 states plus landmarks (Chicago skyline, Gateway Arch, Empire State, Liberty Bell, Mount Rushmore, Nashville, New Orleans Mardi Gras, "Cowboy Texas"). It focuses on Dachshunds and French Bulldogs.

- **Occasions:** travel/hometown gifting, souvenir
- **Gaps:** zero traction/sales; single-breed focus; no personalization

Cross-lane patterns

- **Comfort Colors is the dominant premium blank** across all lanes (SChousebyDaniel, ModPawsUS, CustombyTexas, UIdeaAtelier); Gildan is the budget option.
- **Photo/name personalization is the #1 conversion driver** in Lanes 1–2 — the biggest structural gap for KWW, which has none.

- **Local/hometown dog is genuine white space.** No dominant shop owns "city/state + dog"; UIdeaAtelier shows the format but has essentially no sales. KWW's Waco-skyline + breed system is a defensible, unique position.
- **Palettes skew earthy** (Comfort Colors Pepper, Moss, Espresso, Bay, Blue Jean, Ivory), whereas KWW leans White/Black/Navy/Natural.
- **Recurring occasions:** Christmas, Mother's Day, birthday, memorial/rescue-adoption, Halloween.

How Keep Waco Wagging compares

KWW is a **very new store** (~June 2026) — a Printify-fulfilled retail brand of the Platinum Scoops pet-care business in Waco, TX. It currently has **84 active products** across T-Shirts (26), Sweatshirts (16), Hoodies (16), tote Bags (16), Mugs (3), pet Bandanas/tanks (3), Stickers (3), and 1 Hat, spanning **16 breeds**. Prices: tees \$18.82–33.99, sweatshirts \$48, hoodies \$58, totes \$25–26, mugs \$13.99–40.83, stickers \$4–6, hat \$39.60.

Its design system is the standout differentiator: the **Waco skyline** (Alico Building, suspension bridge, McLennan County Courthouse, Magnolia silos) combined with breed art, a "Keep Waco Wagging" wordmark, and a Platinum Scoops badge — a local/hometown + breed hybrid.

Dimension	Keep Waco Wagging	Lane 1	Lane 2	Lane 3
Catalog size	84 products	Moderate graphic/drinkware lines	20+ product types, huge breadth	~50–188 items
Personalization	None	Minimal (some name mugs)	Core (photo + name)	Free custom / none
Premium blank	Printify (Gildan/BC class)	Gildan / Comfort Colors	Comfort Colors	Comfort Colors
Colors	White/Black/Navy/Natural	White/Black/Navy	Earth tones	Earth tones
Local/hometown angle	Strong (Waco identity)	None	None	Emerging only
Sales proxy	Very new (~\$190/90d)	3K–8K	158K–296K	0–23K

Comparison is on **assortment and positioning**, not sales parity — KWW is weeks old versus multi-year, six-figure-sale competitors.

Gaps & opportunities (prioritized)

1. **Add photo + name personalization (HIGH).** ModPawsUS (296K sales) and SChousebyDaniel built their businesses on it. Launch a "Your Dog + Waco Skyline" custom tee (upload photo or type dog name onto the skyline design).
2. **Offer a Comfort Colors premium tier (HIGH).** It dominates every top shop and commands \$18.99–29.91. Add earth-tone colorways (Pepper, Moss, Bay, Ivory) alongside current Printify blanks.

3. **Own the city/state + dog white space (HIGH).** Nobody dominant owns it. Template the Waco skyline system to Austin, Dallas, Houston, and San Antonio to be first-mover on Texas hometown-dog merch.
4. **Broaden the earthy palette (MEDIUM).** Add Moss, Bay, Blue Jean, Espresso, and Ivory to hero designs to match category expectations.
5. **Build gifting-occasion collections (MEDIUM).** Christmas, Mother's Day, memorial/rainbow-bridge, and Gotcha Day collections — occasions every top competitor merchandises.
6. **Add a dog-worn apparel line (MEDIUM).** [natruyenshop](#) (158K sales) proves demand for apparel worn by the dog. KWW already has bandanas — extend into a "Waco pup" dog-worn line.
7. **Add breed-silhouette / line-art designs (MEDIUM).** [SChousebyDaniel](#)'s dog-ears line art is a bestseller format; add breed-ear line-art variants of the Waco designs.
8. **Consider an Etsy storefront (STRATEGIC).** Star Seller badges and review volume drive Etsy search ranking; KWW is Shopify-only and misses breed/hometown search demand and review social proof.
9. **Dog-sport & activity niche (LOW).** [DoggieMerch](#) targets agility/dock-diving — underserved but low-volume; optional "Waco Agility" community tees could deepen the local moat.

Sources: individual Etsy shop pages linked inline (PupMoms, PeaceLovePups, SChousebyDaniel, ModPawsUS, natruyenshop, CustombyTexas, DoggieMerch, UIdeaAtelier), collected late June / July 2026. Keep Waco Wagging catalog data from the connected Shopify store.